helicopter flying hours, road building and maintenance of tracks in a combat zone. In cases where receipts are not available, DoD procedures provide for the use of a comparison with U.S. costs for similar operations as an important tool in analyzing reasonableness.

DoD Responses to GAO Recommendations

- RECOMMENDATION 1: The GAO recommends that the Secretary of Defense consistently implement existing criteria to disallow or defer Pakistani claims that do not supply the documentation needed to verify their claims. (p. 39/GAO Draft Report)

  DOD RESPONSE: Partially concur. The Department concurs with the importance of following a set of criteria to support approval of payments while simultaneously accommodating the fact that partner countries often do not have financial systems, recordkeeping procedures, and data transparency comparable to the United States. The Department has clarified its guidance to emphasize the criteria used to approve payments when invoices, receipts, or contracts are not available to substantiate claims. Such criteria will include non-financial indicators such as the size and scope of the mission for which costs are claimed. In the absence of detailed documentation, the Department will continue to evaluate claims under authority provided by statute.

- RECOMMENDATION 2: The GAO recommends that the Secretary of Defense define and formalize the roles and responsibilities of the Office of Defense Representative to Pakistan (ODRP). (p. 39/GAO Draft Report)

  DOD RESPONSE: Concur. The Department updated its guidance to clarify the roles and responsibilities of the U.S. Embassy personnel assigned to interact with cooperating nations on the subject of CSF reimbursements.

- RECOMMENDATION 3: The GAO recommends that the Secretary of Defense work with the Government of Pakistan to develop procedures to allow the Office of Defense Representative to Pakistan or other U.S. representatives to conduct greater oversight of coalition support funds use in Pakistan, including the potential use of on-site monitoring. (p. 39/GAO Draft Report)

  DOD RESPONSE: Concur. The Government of Pakistan does not permit access to the FATA to U.S. forces; therefore, certain operations require Pakistani forces to perform actions unaccompanied by U.S. on-site monitors. Pakistan has legitimate concerns about the safety of U.S. government representatives on tribal territory when they are operating in such close proximity to Al Qaeda and/or the Taliban. Because CSF is a reimbursement for expenses already incurred by Pakistan, on-site monitoring is not a realistic verification requirement. However,

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